Ahmad A. Kholaif

Senior Full-Stack Engineer | Node.js · Go · TypeScript · React · AWS & GCP

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Summary

Senior Software Engineer with 7+ years of experience building scalable backend services, full-stack applications, integrations, and cloud infrastructure across fintech, food-tech, and the public sector. With hands-on experience in microservices, distributed integrations, cloud migrations, performance optimization, and reliability. Experienced in building payment and integration systems and using AI-assisted development tools to accelerate delivery while maintaining engineering quality.

Experience

Senior Software Engineer | Full Stack Developer

Fena.co – Open Banking and Ecommerce Solutions *— Remote | London, UK*
Apr 2023 – Present

Tech Stack: Node.js, TypeScript, Go, React.js, Next.js, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, AWS, GCP, Distributed Services.
AWS Services: Lambda, EC2, RDS, CodeArtifact, CloudFront, S3, Elastic Beanstalk, Secrets Manager, Load Balancing, Cognito, CloudWatch, SQS.
GCP Services: App Engine, Cloud Run, Cloud SQL PostgreSQL, Load Balancing, Pub/Sub, Cloud Storage.

- Built and maintained backend services in Node.js/TypeScript and Go using PostgreSQL and MongoDB, powering payment, invoicing, accounting, and integration workflows.
- Designed and evolved an integration hub connecting accounting, ecommerce, and shipping platforms including Xero, QuickBooks, Shopify, and ShipEngine.
- Standardized integration patterns and tooling, reducing the effort required to onboard and maintain third-party integrations.
- Use AI-assisted engineering tools including Claude Code, Cursor, and Codex for feature development, refactoring, test generation, debugging, and code review while maintaining engineering and review standards.
- Built payment integrations with PSPs including Stripe, Ryft, and Niftipay, supporting card and crypto payment flows.

Senior Software Engineer | Founding Team Member

The Food Lab – Cloud Kitchen Operations *— Hybrid | Cairo, Egypt*
Dec 2021 – Apr 2023

Tech Stack: Node.js, React.js, PostgreSQL, AWS, GCP, Airbyte, DBT, Docker.
AWS Services: Lambda, EC2, RDS, S3, Elastic Beanstalk, Secrets Manager, Load Balancing, CloudWatch.
GCP Services: App Engine, Cloud Run, Cloud SQL PostgreSQL, Load Balancing, Cloud Compute.

- Designed and built core systems from the ground up as a founding team member, including order aggregation, recipe management, and cost-management platforms.
- Led the migration of services from GCP to AWS, improving scalability and availability while reducing cloud infrastructure costs.
- Implemented data pipelines with Airbyte and dbt, enabling near-real-time reporting and improving operational visibility and decision-making.
- Adopted open-source Metabase to expand data access and reduce tooling costs.

Software Engineer | Full Stack Developer

IBM *— Hybrid | Cairo, Egypt*
Aug 2020 – Dec 2021

Tech Stack: Node.js, React.js, TypeScript, Kubernetes, IBM Cloud, Grafana, Elasticsearch, k6, InfluxDB, Python.

- Developed backend services for TAMM Abu Dhabi's digital transformation (UAE-based).
- Optimized maritime shipping workflows in the TradeLens platform (USA-based).
- Automated performance testing using K6, InfluxDB, and Grafana, improving testing accuracy and reducing manual work.
- Managed cloud-native deployments using Kubernetes and IBM Cloud.
- Mentored junior developers and facilitated onboarding for new hires.
- Received the **IBM Excellence Award** for delivering reliable, scalable services to public sector clients.

Software Engineer | Full Stack Developer

Fixed Solutions *— Hybrid | Cairo, Egypt*
Jun 2019 – Aug 2020

Tech Stack: Node.js, React.js, MongoDB, Redis, Docker, Jenkins, Identity Management, Elasticsearch, Kibana.

- Built scalable full-stack web applications for public sector modernization initiatives.
- Maintained CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins and Docker, reducing deployment errors and cycle time.
- Implemented secure identity management solutions across government platforms.
- Delivered backend systems for Egypt's electricity modernization project (EEHC / Digital Egypt).
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to meet project milestones on time.

Education

Information Technology Institute (ITI) — Cairo, Egypt
Professional Diploma in Open Source Web Application Development
Oct 2018 – May 2019

Suez University — Suez, Egypt
B.Sc. in Petroleum Engineering
Sep 2009 – May 2014

Technical Skills & Tools

Languages & Frameworks: JavaScript, TypeScript, Go, Node.js, Express.js, NestJS, React.js, Next.js, Python.

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MySQL, Redis, InfluxDB.

Cloud & DevOps: AWS | GCP, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Serverless, GitHub Actions.

Architecture: Cloud-native applications, microservices, distributed integrations, event-driven systems, CI/CD, serverless

Monitoring & Testing: Grafana, Kibana, Elasticsearch, K6 Load / Performance Testing, Metabase.

Others: Agile, REST APIs, GraphQL, System Design & Architecture.

AI-Assisted Engineering: Claude Code, Cursor, Codex.

Languages: - ***English*** *Proficient* - ***Arabic*** *Native*